*03/11/2026*
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*OPR: WVOT Cybersecurity*

**COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY**

*Publications are available online at*
*https://sites.google.com/wv.gov/othub/policy-governance/ot-policies*

Questions and change recommendations related to this publication shall be directed to this publication's Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR). This policy shall be reviewed annually to ensure continued alignment with current legal, operational, and strategic requirements. Revisions will be undertaken as necessary.

**SUMMARY OF VERSIONS AND CHANGES**

| Version | Date | Revision Description |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 03/11/2026 | Reformatted and changed the wording in paragraph 3.5.1 and added 3.5.2 and 3.6.3. |
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## 1. PURPOSE

1.1. This policy prescribes practices intended to mitigate the potential risks of international travel that include but are not limited to loss and theft, use of unsecured foreign networks, search and seizure of equipment by foreign governments, business and government competition, and malicious actors.

## 2. SCOPE

2.1. This policy applies to all departments (including agencies, boards, authorities, and commissions) within the Executive Branch of WV State Government, excluding constitutional officers, the WV Board of Education, the WV Department of Education, and the county boards of education that have access to or use State-provided resources.

2.2. Where there are policies in place which provide less restrictions or security than this policy, those policies will be superseded by this policy. In instances where existing state and federal laws, regulations, and policies are more restrictive than this policy, The more restrictive provisions will prevail.

## 3. POLICY

3.1. Limitations of Data Storage and Devices in Possession

3.1.1. International travelers should limit the number of devices they carry on their person to reduce their risk of exposure by not bringing extra or unnecessary devices.

3.1.1.1. Devices should be encrypted and locked at all times when not in use using strong passwords and secure locking techniques.

3.1.1.2. Device Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and security patches should be current prior to leaving for the trip.

3.1.2. International travelers should limit the amount of data stored on devices while traveling and limit the access to it.

3.1.2.1. Prior to leaving, back-up necessary business-related data to another device or cloud service.

3.1.2.2. Remove or provide exceptional protection of information that might be considered sensitive by foreign/host governments, and any information defined as confidential or restricted by the State's Data Classification Policy.

3.1.2.3. Carry mobile electronic equipment as carry-on luggage instead of checked baggage so it remains on their person following guidelines recommended by Transportation Safety Administration (TSA).

3.1.2.4. Travelers shall not connect to State Network via VPN unless they get prior authorization from the Cybersecurity Office.

3.2. Agencies that require out of country travel will have dedicated computers for use during the trip.

3.2.1. These devices shall be loaded with basic tools such as Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Absolute Computrace, and the Cybersecurity Office managed EDR solution and will limit the amount of available data to minimize the risk if the device is stolen, lost or seized by foreign governments. The device must be encrypted.

3.2.2. These devices shall use a local account not connected to the EXECUTIVE domain.

3.2.3. Smartphones can store a lot of information about how you access the State's systems and often do not provide a level of protection comparable to larger systems. Simple cell phones are a better choice when traveling to high risk countries.

3.3. Adopt Safe Practices for Traveling With Electronic Devices.

3.3.1. Assume everything you do on your devices is being intercepted.

3.3.2. The information that you send over a network may be monitored, even when using a hotel or business connection. It is always best to assume you are being monitored so that you can adjust your actions accordingly.

3.3.3. Keep your device with you at all times and do not let your devices leave your sight. Should customs or other airport officials take your devices out of your view, those devices should be considered compromised and should not be used. Even if you will not be using your device, it should not be left in a hotel room, vehicle, conference center, or foreign office unattended.

3.3.4. Do not use unknown storage devices.

3.3.5. USB keys can be used to install malicious software on your devices and allow unauthorized individuals to compromise your data and accounts.

3.3.6. Only plug items into your devices that you have brought with you.

3.3.7. Public charging stations at airports or hotels should also be avoided, as they can transmit harmful software to your devices.

3.3.8. Be aware of your surroundings when logging in and inputting data.

3.4. Notify OT immediately if a theft or loss occurs.

3.4.1. In case a laptop or mobile device is lost or stolen, contact the OT Service Desk to report the incident immediately. From that point a Privacy Office incident will need to be reported at https://wv.accessgov.com/technology/Forms/Page/incident-reporting/incident-reporting/.

3.5. Devices that return Stateside

3.5.1. Loaner devices should not be connected to the network once back in the United States.

3.5.2. Upon returning the device must be scanned before transferring the data to the state network.

3.6. Unauthorized Out of the US Travel

3.6.1. If authorized travel overseas is going to occur the agency needs to contact the Cybersecurity Office (cso@wv.gov) three business days before the dates of travel. With the timeline of the travel, the user who is traveling along with the pc name.

3.6.2. Devices that are detected outside of the US without prior authorization will be frozen. The agency Privacy Officer will be contacted.

3.6.3. Once the user is back in the United States the freeze will be removed from the device. The user should contact the service desk to initiate the freeze removal.

## 4. POLICY SPECIFIC DEFINITIONS

4.1. Chief Information Officer (CIO) - the person designated by the governor to lead the WV Office of Technology and oversee information technology practices and initiatives for the Executive Brand of WV State government, excluding the constitutional officers.

4.2. Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) - Person designated by the CTO to oversee information security practices and initiatives for the Executive Branch of WV State government, excluding the constitutional officers.

4.3. Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) - a solution designed to continuously monitor endpoints for suspicious activity, looking for patterns and anomalies that might indicate a threat in real-time.

4.4. Information Security – Those measures, procedures, and controls that provide an acceptable degree of safety for information resources, protecting them from accidental or intentional disclosure, modification, or destruction.

4.5. Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) - The primary section within WVOT that takes the lead on a specific policy or procedure. Usually the WVOT service provider/owner that the policy is related to or governs.

4.6. Threat – Includes any person, condition, or circumstance that endangers the security of information or information systems in the context of information security.

4.7. West Virginia Office of Technology (WVOT) - The division of the Department of Administration established by WV Code § 5A-6-4a, et. seq., which is led by the State's CIO and designated to acquire, operate, and maintain the State's technology infrastructure. The WVOT is responsible for evaluating equipment and services, and reviewing information technology contracts.

## 5. RELEVANT MATERIALS AND DOCUMENTS

5.1. 45 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) §§ 164.308-316

5.2. Freedom of Information Act

5.3. Gramm-Leach Bliley Act (GLBA)

5.4. Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Privacy Rule

5.5. NIST SP 800-14 and NIST SP 800-53

5.6. State Health Privacy Laws

5.7. WV Code § 5A-6-4a

5.8. WV Executive Order No. 7-03

5.9. WVOT Policies Issued by the Chief Information Officer (CIO), https://sites.google.com/wv.gov/othub/policy-governance/ot-policies